PRODUCT WORKING GUIDE

Projects, evidence and payment flows

A detailed guide to project creation, invitations, work reviews, receipts, installments and approved price changes.

Product behavior reference · 14 November 2026

01	02	03
Work approval	**Money received**	**Permission to proceed**
Has the client approved the construction updates?	Has the contractor confirmed the actual payment?	May current work or the next stage continue?

These are separate decisions. Approved work can still have an unpaid balance. Recording money received does not automatically authorize work.

CONTRACTOR-CREATED PROJECT

Evidence → Client approval → Payment for that same stage → Contractor decisions → Next stage

CLIENT-CREATED PROJECT

Payment and work authorization → Evidence → Client approval → Progression check → Next stage

> **How to use this guide**
>
> This describes the current implementation and the latest decisions in the working sessions and chat. It is a reference for the comprehensive test, not a statement that every scenario has passed live. The latest invitation, notification and navigation changes still require their matching release.

Inside this guide

Roles · Creation and BOQs · Invitations · Both project origins · Full and split payments · Partial balances · Receipt exceptions · Currency · Price changes · Notifications · Remaining work · Acceptance checklist

WORKFLOW REFERENCE

Responsibilities

Project role	Responsibilities
Primary client	Approves construction updates and price proposals, chooses/proposes payment plans, uploads payment receipts and invites eligible participants.
Primary contractor	Uploads construction updates, proposes stage prices, reviews installment plans, confirms received money, authorizes current work and explicitly authorizes progression with a balance.
Additional contractor	Uploads construction updates and collaborates; does not replace the primary contractor's financial/pricing authority or gain invitation management.
Observer / family	Reads project progress, costs, documents and conversations; can participate in conversation, including permitted attachments. Cannot approve, submit stage evidence, upload payment receipts or change prices.
Assigned verifier	Reviews assigned verification work in its own workflow. This does not replace the primary client/contractor payment responsibilities.

Account role and project role are distinct. An admin correcting someone's account role changes their general dashboard, while accepted project responsibilities remain explicit. Saved creation origin does not change when an account role changes.

Who can manage invitations?

The primary client and primary contractor manage the eligible invitations. Additional contractors and observers cannot invite people or promote themselves. An administrator has separate account and project administration tools.

If the client wants to edit a stage price

The normal interaction is a contractor proposal followed by client approval. The client can approve or keep current prices. A price change can increase or reduce the shared project total. The full process is explained on page 10.

WORKFLOW REFERENCE

Creation and invitations

Both origins save one project and one shared stage schedule. An uploaded confirmed BOQ supplies the project's native total and precision without extra Groundwork fees. Standard percentage/fixed/zero rules distribute it across all stages and retain the same sum. A mid-build start records previous stages as completed with their values; it does not turn those values into zero or invent received-payment records.

The sender chooses a role before generating a link. The first contractor can be the primary contractor; later contractor invitations are additional assignments. There is one primary client. Family is observer access. An email invitation remains available alongside the link option. Choosing a dropdown option alone sends nothing.

A new invitee signs up and verifies their account; an existing invitee signs in. The role and original project context survive confirmation/MFA/recovery. Required contractor onboarding is completed only when necessary. The recipient joins the existing project in the chosen role rather than creating another project. Independent contractor signup grants standard access, not automatic certification or directory/partner standing.

Shared links do not expire and can be withdrawn. Only the first eligible verified account can claim one; a retry by that account is safe. Email-bound invitations must match the invited address. Another account, a revoked invitation or an already assigned member cannot use a link to acquire a different project privilege.

> **Confirmed BOQ example**
>
> A BOQ total of **141,407,337.524** stays the confirmed native total. Its saved stage allocations sum to that figure, without additional BOQ fees. A later client-approved revision can change the agreed total while preserving the original document.

WORKFLOW REFERENCE

Contractor-created project: repeating cycle

1. The contractor creates the project and invites its primary client.
2. The current unfinished stage is available for contractor construction updates. Uploads can be added before the client joins, but a client must join to review.
3. The client views and approves the required substage updates. The final required approval triggers the main-stage approval check.
4. Approved work remains on that stage awaiting its own payment. Receipt controls become available for this reviewed stage. The next stage remains gated.
5. The client submits the stage's receipt(s), using full payment or the agreed installment arrangement.
6. The primary contractor confirms whether money arrived and separately decides whether current work is authorized. A receipt upload or reader match alone does not count as money received.
7. With approved work, received funds/work authorization and full settlement, the stage completes and the next stage opens for evidence. If money is outstanding, the contractor must explicitly authorize next-stage progression to move on.
8. The same evidence-first cycle repeats for every later live stage.

Payment after approval belongs to the reviewed stage, including the first live stage of a mid-build project. Completing Stage 4 does not ask for Stage 5 payment before Stage 5 evidence on this origin.

> **Stage 4 into Stage 5**
>
> The contractor uploads Stage 4 updates. The client approves Stage 4 and pays for Stage 4. After settlement or explicit progression permission, Stage 5 opens for its own evidence. This repeats at every live stage.

WORKFLOW REFERENCE

Client-created project: repeating cycle

1. The client creates the project and invites its primary contractor.
2. The current unfinished stage starts with payment. The client submits proof for that stage and the contractor reviews it.
3. Confirming received money alone does not authorize work. The contractor must also allow work; a split plan must be accepted before work is authorized.
4. When authorized, the contractor uploads that stage's required evidence.
5. The client reviews and approves it. Paid money alone never approves construction.
6. With approved work and full settlement the stage completes; the next stage awaits its own payment/work authorization. With a remaining balance, explicit progression authorization is still required.
7. Repeat payment → authorized work/evidence → client approval for later live stages.

If the client submits a receipt before the contractor has joined, it is pending until the primary contractor joins and reviews it. An observer or additional contractor cannot perform that financial confirmation.

> **Stage 4 into Stage 5**
>
> The client funds Stage 4, and the contractor authorizes work. The contractor uploads Stage 4 updates for client approval. Once the progression conditions are met, Stage 5 awaits its own funding and work authorization.

WORKFLOW REFERENCE

Full payment and two installments

The plan concerns a stage's agreed price; it does not move money or change the project budget. Full payment is the default, and saving a full-payment plan needs no separate contractor acceptance of the plan itself. Receipts still need review.

For two installments, the client enters a positive first amount below the stage total. The second is the remainder; it need not be 50/50. The primary contractor accepts the arrangement or requests a revision. Receipt evidence can be submitted while a split plan is awaiting review, but the unaccepted arrangement cannot authorize work/progression. A declined plan requires revision before new receipts.

Several receipts may count toward installment 1 or 2. For a stage of 1,000,000 XAF, a 600,000 / 400,000 split might have 200,000 and 400,000 receipts for the first installment and 150,000 and 250,000 for the second. Each file retains its amount, currency, installment association and decision. Confirmed amounts total the same 1,000,000. An installment is not a limit of one file.

Plans are normally chosen before receipts/funding. Declined plans can be revised where allowed; previously submitted proof keeps its original history. The UI does not silently retag or overwrite old receipts when a plan changes.

Plan	Separate receipt files	Planned total
Installment 1	200,000 + 400,000 XAF	600,000 XAF
Installment 2	150,000 + 250,000 XAF	400,000 XAF
Whole stage	**Four proofs, individually reviewed**	**1,000,000 XAF**

WORKFLOW REFERENCE

The three separate decisions

Decision	Effect
Was this money received? No	Record a reason/flag. It does not reduce the confirmed balance or unlock work.
Received: record only	Reduce the balance by the confirmed amount. Do not grant current work permission.
Received: request more	Record actual received money and request a bounded top-up; keep work/progression gated.
Received: allow current work	Permit work where the stage/accepted plan allows it; retain any unpaid balance.
Allow next stage with balance	After work approval and received funds, explicitly confirm progression. Keep the amount owed against the original stage.

For a 1,000,000 XAF stage with 600,000 confirmed, the remaining amount is 400,000. Allowing current work does not make that 400,000 paid and does not itself authorize the next stage. Once work is approved, the contractor can wait for settlement or confirm progression with debt. Later payments reduce the same old balance without reopening work or skipping the current construction stage.

Confirmation dialogs show the affected amount and consequence. Canceling writes nothing. A stale receipt, price or plan must be refreshed before confirmation. The contractor can also return to confirmed received funds and authorize work later while another receipt is still pending. That action does not confirm the pending receipt or include it in the received total.

> **Full settlement still needs approved work**
>
> If all money has been received but the work has not been approved, the stage does not complete automatically. If the work is approved and a balance remains, the primary contractor decides whether to wait or explicitly authorize progression.

WORKFLOW REFERENCE

Receipt submission and exceptions

The client selects a file or camera capture, selects the currency printed on that proof and enters its exact amount. The reader checks the document independently of that typed amount. Each queued file is checked/submitted separately; selecting several files does not authorize treating all of them as one transfer.

- Successfully read unrelated image: request a real payment receipt.
- Unreadable proof: request a clearer image/document.
- Amount/currency mismatch: correct the input/selection or use the right proof. A valid partial amount is compared with the receipt, not forced to equal the full stage price.
- Reader/provider unavailable: keep the file/input and offer retry. It cannot be classified as a valid receipt or credited without a successful check.
- Pending proof: visible in history but separate from confirmed received totals.
- Flagged or unconfirmed incorrect proof: replace it while retaining the original and replacement relationship. Replaced proof is excluded from balance totals.
- Confirmed proof: remains immutable; the replacement action is unavailable.
- More payments: add separate receipts. One receipt must not be reused to count money twice or assigned to two stages.
- Received money above a later revised price: retain actual history and show no negative payable balance. This does not implement an automatic refund or move excess money to another stage.

Groundwork records evidence of payments made outside the application and the contractor's acknowledgment. Reading a receipt does not independently verify bank settlement or initiate another transfer.

WORKFLOW REFERENCE

Currency, historical work and special states

Both views share the saved project budget and receipt snapshots. The receipt's original amount/currency, receipt-to-USD conversion and USD-to-project conversion remain recorded. A later browser market quote does not silently change an agreed BOQ or old payment. The interface distinguishes source/save time/provider quote date; an unavailable original historical quote date is not invented.

Zero-cost stages require no payment; their normal applicable work/review rules still apply. A later explicitly approved price revision can change an originally zero stage. Missing/unknown prices are not automatically free.

For a mid-build 8,000,000 XAF project with 2,000,000 of previously completed work, the whole recorded project value remains 8,000,000 and the remaining managed work starts at 6,000,000 before new confirmed payments. The historical 2,000,000 is not rewritten as zero or fabricated as a new contractor receipt.

Future stages cannot be used to skip incomplete earlier work. On-hold work does not automatically resume because a receipt exists; permitted financial history for completed stages remains separate. Archived projects remain read-only. Final work completion creates no next-stage prompt. If progression was authorized with debt, later balance receipts remain possible after work/project completion.

> WHERE CROSS-CURRENCY CONVERSION IS REQUIRED
>
> **Receipt amount ÷ saved receipt currency per USD × saved project currency per USD**
>
> Both conversion legs and the original receipt amount remain recorded.

WORKFLOW REFERENCE

Stage price changes and what a client can edit

The normal client workflow is **review/approve**, not originating a contractor price proposal. The primary contractor selects proposed zero or positive prices, sees each before/after amount and the revised project total, and confirms submission. Every stage is eligible, including completed, zero and historical stages, subject to the project's writable status. The project total must remain positive.

While pending, the existing approved budget continues to apply. The primary client reviews the exact proposal and confirms approval or keeping current prices. The contractor can withdraw an undecided proposal. There is one pending proposal per project. Canceling or reverting a draft edit does not record a price change.

Approval updates the agreed stage prices and project total together for both views. Raising one stage by 100,000 normally raises the total by 100,000; it does not silently deduct that amount from other stages. The original BOQ and previous approved/declined proposals remain history. Declining a new proposal never changes an earlier approved proposal. Actual received amounts and completed work remain recorded. An increase may create another outstanding balance; a reduction may remove a payment gate. The system does not invent a payment or reopen historical work to make those figures match.

Changes in receipts, assignments or project prices while a proposal is open can make it stale. It must be refreshed/recreated rather than approving outdated figures. Editing substage names, scope or adding new substages is separate deferred functionality, not a consequence of changing a stage price.

Example	Before proposal	After client approval
Selected stage	1,000,000 XAF	1,200,000 XAF
Project total	10,000,000 XAF	10,200,000 XAF
Previously received money	Recorded actual amount	Same recorded actual amount

WORKFLOW REFERENCE

Notifications, guidance and return links

The latest local notification implementation sends meaningful project events to accepted participants, normally excluding the person performing the action. Pending/revoked members are excluded; existing invitees have acceptance notices and joining users get project-ready notices. Private staff notes stay private.

Clicks resolve current project membership and open the right workspace and exact stage/receipt/proposal/document/conversation/message. Approvers get the applicable controls; observers get the read view. Clicking a notice never approves or confirms money by itself. Read status synchronizes across the bell/list, and unread counts include older records. Revoked access produces an access error, not another project's screen.

Back uses an explicit role-aware document link, with visible mobile text and loading/error escape paths. BOQ-editor Back retains the relevant authoring/project tab. The original reported live failure remains part of the later deployed review.

Completed actions suppress their walkthrough tips. Activation email reminders are the separate signup/onboarding/invitation Day 1/3/7 framework; they do not confirm payments. Actual email launch configuration and direct Meta WhatsApp integration remain separate work, listed later in this guide.

IMPLEMENTATION STATUS

Remaining implementation and release work

1. **Release this latest link/notification/navigation work.** Apply unapplied `20261114000400_project_invitation_role_selection.sql`, then `20261114000500_project_action_notifications.sql`, and deploy the matching application. Back changes alone require no database migration. Earlier release confirmation is not confirmation of these newer changes.
2. **Build direct Meta lifecycle WhatsApp.** Account/number setup is outstanding. The existing sender is not a complete automation: approved English/French reminder templates, independent channel scheduling/snapshots, signed inbound and delivery webhooks, deduplication, Admin conversations/replies, reply pause, consent/STOP and uncertain-send reconciliation are still needed. See Meta setup and integration work.
3. **Finish email launch configuration.** At the last recorded scoped check, `mail.tryjalla.com` was verified for sending, receiving was off, no signed Resend webhook/reply domain was configured, and managed delivery/journeys were disabled. Verify sender domains and current sender settings, dedicated receiving DNS, webhook secret/subscriptions, reply routing, staff owner/cadence and the controlled recipient cohort. These are configuration/launch items, not missing reminder-engine code. That earlier check must not be presented as a new live verification.
4. **Retire overlapping legacy activation reminders.** The supplied GHL inventory identifies `Groundwork Lifecycle Events` as the candidate. Branch-level retirement remains unconfirmed. Keep unrelated application/acquisition/ subscription workflows intact. Current Groundwork ownership guards do not prove that an already enrolled legacy workflow has stopped.
5. **Run the comprehensive acceptance after implementation.** The user explicitly wants this later. Include all four account journeys, new/existing invitees, primary/additional/observer/family roles, both payment origins, every payment decision, installments and mixed receipts, history/pricing, Back/action links, English/French delivery, real receipt reading, email/WhatsApp replies and actual Day-7 staff recovery. Automated local checks do not establish live acceptance.

> **What has already been checked locally**
>
> 225 focused UI/unit tests in 14 files passed, along with TypeScript checking, the production build and isolated PostgreSQL payment/notification regressions. These checks do not replace the comprehensive deployed test.

FOLLOW-ON SCOPE

Deferred work and team follow-up

Item	Why it remains
Custom substage creation/editing	Explicitly stacked for a later rollout. Needs scope/order/evidence/history and approval rules. Editing stage prices does not implement editing substages.
Full prepaid / pre-platform payment-history onboarding	Explicitly deferred in the Nov 12 discussion. Historical completed values exist, but a complete opening-payment questionnaire/import is not established.
Device-level duplicate-user detection	Marked future scope in the Nov 2 review. Email uniqueness does not establish device identity, and existing evidence location data is not device-level duplicate prevention.
Shorter project links	Lower priority in the Nov 13 transcript; trustworthy first-party role-bound links are implemented. No new short-code service is claimed.
Continuing nurture campaign after “no project”	The framework mentions moving to nurture. The pause/segmentation exists; a separate recurring nurture email campaign has no agreed copy/cadence and is not implemented as another active sequence.
Verification revenue flow and contractor bidding	Explicit next phase after successful full-workflow acceptance. Existing verifier screens are not proof the entire revenue/bidding business process is complete.
Operational sign-off / materials	Philip/Ruth's staffing, precise brand review, representative receipts, welcome-video recording, user review calls and individual test recordings are team actions. A popup walkthrough is implemented; it does not constitute a newly recorded welcome video.

These items are listed separately so deferred scope is not confused with a broken payment feature or missing release configuration.

> **Decision precedence**
>
> The latest direct decisions govern: Groundwork Admin owns activation automation; Meta WhatsApp is the next phase; links have no expiration; multiple receipts can count toward two installments; and client-approved revisions can affect every stage.

LATER ACCEPTANCE

Comprehensive test checklist (1/2)

Run this after implementation and release, using controlled accounts. Record results and compare both participant views after each saved decision.

Use case	What to confirm
Both creation origins	Run complete repeating stage cycles for a client-created and contractor-created project.
BOQ correctness	Check the stated grand total, precision, zero fees, exact allocation sum and identical participant figures.
New and existing invitees	Verify signup/login, email confirmation, required onboarding and exact project continuation.
Invitation roles	Exercise primary client, primary/additional contractor, observer and family links; reject privilege escalation.
Single-use links	Check first claim, same-account reopen, second-account refusal and revocation.
Full and split plans	Use full payment and an accepted/revised two-installment plan with several receipts per installment.
Receipt errors	Try an unrelated image, unreadable proof, wrong amount/currency and provider unavailability.
Partial decisions	Record only, request more, allow current work, wait for settlement and authorize progression with debt.

Test the actual action, receipt, balance and destination—not just whether a button is visible.

LATER ACCEPTANCE

Comprehensive test checklist (2/2)

Run this after implementation and release, using controlled accounts. Record results and compare both participant views after each saved decision.

Use case	What to confirm
Pending batches	Authorize work from confirmed money while a separate receipt remains pending and uncounted.
Corrections and duplicates	Replace unconfirmed/flagged proof; preserve confirmed proof and prevent duplicate counting.
Later balances	Pay an old outstanding balance after work completion without reopening or skipping stages.
Pricing and history	Approve/retain/withdraw proposals; edit zero/completed stages; check totals and prior snapshots.
Currency	Compare saved project/receipt conversions and source/date labels across both participant views.
Stage boundaries	Cover historical, zero, future, final, on-hold and archived stages/projects.
Navigation and notices	Check Back on every dashboard and exact notification targets with read-only observer permissions.
Communication framework	After configuration, verify four journeys, English/French messages, Day 1/3/7, replies, opt-out and human recovery.

Test the actual action, receipt, balance and destination—not just whether a button is visible.